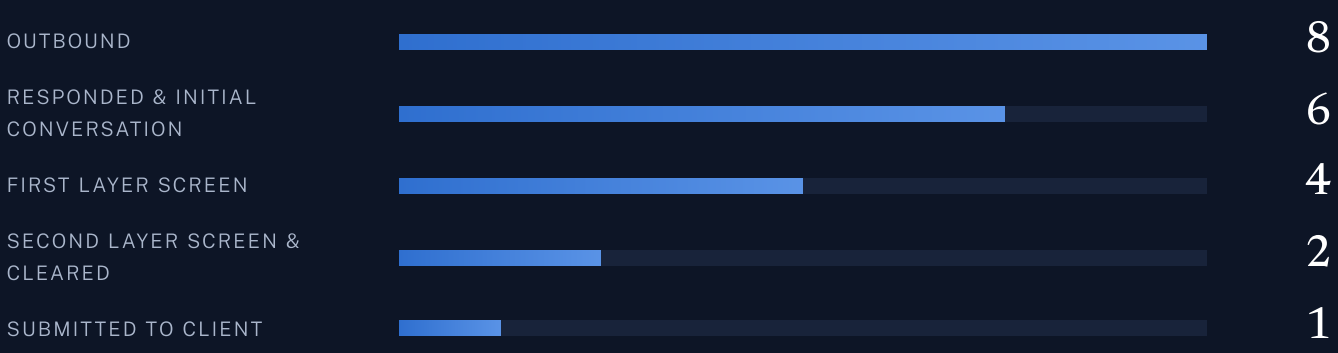
SAMPLE SEARCH PARTNERS *for* Sample Software Co.

SEARCH PIPELINE REPORT

VP Sales

Where the search stands today, drawn from 8 sales leaders across B2B software, services and regional firms in the Washington area and beyond.

OCTOBER 29, 2026



Top 8 candidates, ranked

Our current ranking across every stage of the search, from first conversation through submission.

	CANDIDATE	COMPANY	OUR READ	STAGE
1	**Candidate C** ☆ Regional Sales Director	**Public software company** Washington, DC	The most consistent operator here, at larger scale than the role. Fit with a growth-stage pace is the risk.	First screen
2	**Candidate B** ★ Head of Revenue	**PE-backed services firm** Arlington, VA	Right buyer, right team size and local. The question is the move back from services to software.	Cleared
3	**Candidate A** ☆ VP Sales	**Series C software company** Boston, MA	The strongest scaling record in the pipeline, at exactly this team size. Location is the main open point.	Submitted
4	**Candidate D** ☆ Director of Sales	**Series A startup** Washington, DC	Right stage and clearly motivated, but the team they have led is much smaller than this role needs.	First screen
5	**Candidate F** ☆ Senior Account Executive	**Growth stage software company** Washington, DC	An excellent seller, not yet a sales leader. Not for this search.	Initial conversation
6	**Candidate E** Sales Lead	**Regional agency** Baltimore, MD	Too little in the record to judge. Worth one call before ruling out.	Initial conversation
7	**Candidate G** Chief Commercial Officer	**Seed stage company** Austin, TX	Different market and not open to a move this year.	Outbound
8	**Candidate H** Business Development Manager	**Logistics company** Richmond, VA	Too early in their career for a VP role.	Outbound

★ Direct industry experience ☆ Adjacent industry

WHERE WE'RE FOCUSING NEXT

Candidate B remains our top candidate, with Candidate A and Candidate C close behind. We are moving Candidate A to a second screen focused on relocation and continuing to advance Candidate D as a longer-term option.

Where the search stands

8	6	4	2	1
OUTBOUND	RESPONDED & INITIAL CONVERSATION	FIRST LAYER SCREEN	SECOND LAYER SCREEN & CLEARED	SUBMITTED TO CLIENT

Of 8 leaders worked, 6 responded and had an initial conversation, 4 went through a first layer screen, 2 cleared our second layer screen, and 1 is submitted to you.

CANDIDATE	STAGE	BASE	BONUS	STRONGEST SIGNAL	WATCH ITEM
Candidate C ☆ Public software company	First screen	TBD	TBD	Region at 104 to 112 percent of plan for five straight years, 45 sellers through 5 managers.	Has always had a large company's process behind them; building from scratch is unproven.
Candidate B ★ PE-backed services firm	Cleared	TBD	TBD	Grew revenue 2.3x in four years selling to finance and operations leaders.	Services today; wants to return to software, so ask how fast they would ramp on the product.
Candidate A ☆ Series C software company	Submitted	$250k	$100k	Grew the team from 9 to 31 and revenue from $14M to $41M ARR across two funding rounds.	Based in Boston with family settled there; relocation to DC is open.
Candidate D ☆ Series A startup	First screen	TBD	TBD	Took a Series A from $1M to $4M ARR as its first sales leader.	Team of 5; this role needs 15 to 25.

★ Direct industry experience ☆ Adjacent industry

HOW TO READ THE PIPELINE

01 Scale-led profiles

Candidate A and Candidate C have run teams at or above the size this role needs, with records of hitting plan year after year. The question for both is fit: Candidate A would relocate from Boston, and Candidate C has always had a large company's process behind them.

02 Buyer-led profile

Candidate B sells to finance and operations leaders today, the same buyer this company serves, and is local. The trade-off is the move back from services to software.

03 The compensation picture

One candidate has a current base on file: $250k. [Add targets, bonus, equity and what candidates have told us.]

SECOND LAYER SCREEN & CLEARED

Candidate B ★

Head of Revenue, **PE-backed services firm** · Arlington, VA

WHERE THEY FIT

- Leads 22 people across new business and account growth at a PE-backed firm.
- Sells to the same buyer: finance and operations leaders.
- Ran a software sales region of 8, consistently above plan.

WHERE TO PROBE

? Depth in software pricing and sales cycles.

? Start date: 60 days notice.

CAREER

2020–present — **Head of Revenue**
PE-backed services firm

2015–2020 — **Regional Sales Director**
Mid-market software company

STAGE

Cleared

CURRENT BASE

TBD

BONUS

TBD

EQUITY

TBD

OUR SCREEN

4.1 / 5 Yes

Candidate B: screening scorecard

Scored by our team after the second layer screen. We score critically: a 3 means meets, a 4 is strong, and a 5 is reserved for areas where a candidate is exceptional.

AVERAGE ACROSS 9 CRITERIA

4.1 / 5

OVERALL RECOMMENDATION

Yes

Relevant industry experience and insight Sample note from the team's screen.	5
Building and leading a sales team Sample note from the team's screen.	4
Owning the revenue plan Sample note from the team's screen.	3
Scaling and growth experience Sample note from the team's screen.	5
Sales process and systems Sample note from the team's screen.	4
CEO partnership and commercial acumen Sample note from the team's screen.	3
Account management and expansion Sample note from the team's screen.	5
Location, relocation or commuting Sample note from the team's screen.	4
Ability to be the face in the market Sample note from the team's screen.	4

1 Does not meet · 2 Weak · 3 Meets · 4 Strong · 5 Exceptional

SUBMITTED TO CLIENT

Candidate A ☆

VP Sales, **Series C software company** · Boston, MA

WHERE THEY FIT

- Built and led a 31-person team across new business and account management.
- Took revenue from $14M to $41M ARR at a Series C company.
- Earlier the first sales leader at a Series A, $2M to $9M ARR.

WHERE TO PROBE

? Relocation to Washington, DC and 30 percent travel.

? How much of the buyer base was finance teams.

CAREER

2021–present **VP Sales**
Series C software company

2016–2021 **Director of Sales**
Series A data company

STAGE

Submitted

CURRENT BASE

$250k

BONUS

$100k

EQUITY

TBD

First layer screen

2 candidates have been through our first layer screen. We score candidates once they clear the second layer, so these profiles show what stood out and what we still need to confirm.

Candidate C ☆

Regional Sales Director, Public software company · Washington, DC

SIGNAL Region at 104 to 112 percent of plan for five straight years, 45 sellers through 5 managers.

WATCH Has always had a large company's process behind them; building from scratch is unproven.

Candidate D ☆

Director of Sales, Series A startup · Washington, DC

SIGNAL Took a Series A from $1M to $4M ARR as its first sales leader.

WATCH Team of 5; this role needs 15 to 25.

★ Direct industry experience ☆ Adjacent industry

Responded and initial conversation

2 leaders have responded and had an initial conversation with our team. Candidates with direct or adjacent industry experience are listed first.

NAME	COMPANY	TITLE	INDUSTRY	LOCATION
Candidate F ☆	Growth stage software company	Senior Account Executive	Adjacent	Washington, DC
Candidate E	Regional agency	Sales Lead		Baltimore, MD

★ Direct industry experience ☆ Adjacent industry

Outbound

2 leaders in the pipeline to connect with.

NAME	COMPANY	TITLE	LOCATION
Candidate G	Seed stage company	Chief Commercial Officer	Austin, TX
Candidate H	Logistics company	Business Development Manager	Richmond, VA

★ Direct industry experience ☆ Adjacent industry